



Plants for boundaries, hedges, and windbreaks

Plants make beautiful screens, carving up the space within a yard or a garden, or marking boundaries with foliage and flowers.

Choose from smooth, green walls made from clipped yew or boxwood to set off a formal scheme, or colorful, textured screens using abelia or forsythia for an informal design. Hedges that bear flowers include St. John's wort, lavender, and viburnum, which offer a long season of interest. If watching wildlife is your hobby, make a home for birds, animals, and insects with a medley of crabapple, rose, and hornbeam. Some shrubs can also provide protection, with their thorns helping to keep intruders at bay. So, if security is an issue, select the fiercely armored firethorn or a spiny holly.



SHRUB LARGE

Berberis x stenophylla

HEDGE BARBERRY An arching, prickly evergreen shrub with narrow, spine-tipped dark green leaves, blue-gray beneath. Small yellow spring flowers are followed by small blue-black fruits. Trim lightly in summer after the flowers have faded.

↑10ft (3m) ↔15ft (5m)

☀ Z6–9



TREE LARGE

Carpinus betulus

EUROPEAN HORNBEAM A deciduous tree with oval, veined dark green leaves that turn yellow and orange in fall; young stems retain the dried foliage in winter. Bears green catkins in late spring. Use for formal or wildlife hedging; prune in midsummer.

↑80ft (25m) ↔70ft (20m)

☀ Z4–8



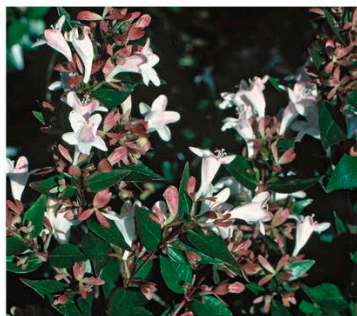
TREE SMALL

Cornus mas

CORNELIAN CHERRY This deciduous tree bears oval green leaves that turn purple in fall. From winter to early spring, small yellow flowers appear on bare shoots, followed by edible fruits. Use it as a screening plant; prune in early summer.

↑25ft (8m) ↔20ft (6m)

☀ Z4–8



SHRUB LARGE

Abelia x grandiflora

GLOSSY ABELIA This is an arching deciduous or semievergreen shrub with oval green leaves that are bronze when young. From midsummer to fall, it produces masses of trumpet-shaped, pink-tinged white blooms. Clip in spring.

↑10ft (3m) ↔12ft (4m)

☀ Z6–9



SHRUB MEDIUM

Buxus sempervirens **'Elegantissima'**

COMMON BOXWOOD This rounded, compact evergreen shrub has oval green leaves with white margins. It makes a dense, waist-high formal hedge; clip twice a year in early and late summer.

↑↔5ft (1.5m)

☀ ☹ Z6–8



SHRUB LARGE

Corylus avellana

EUROPEAN FILBERT A large spreading shrub or small tree with rounded, deeply veined green leaves that turn yellow in fall. Yellow catkins in spring are followed by edible nuts in fall. Ideal for attracting wildlife; prune in late winter.

↑↔15ft (5m)

☀ Z4–8



SHRUB MEDIUM

Berberis julianae

WINTERGREEN BARBERRY An evergreen shrub with glossy, oval dark green leaves, spiny stems, and yellow late spring flowers followed by blue-black fruits. Trim lightly in summer after the blooms have faded. Use as a formidable anti-intruder hedge.

↑8ft (2.5m) ↔10ft (3m)

☀ Z6–8



SHRUB SMALL

Buxus sempervirens **'Suffruticosa'**

COMMON BOXWOOD This slow-growing, compact evergreen shrub has woody stems of small, oval green leaves. Ideal for topiary and for low, formal hedges or border edging. Clip twice a year in early and late summer.

↑3ft (1m) ↔5ft (1.5m)

☀ ☹ Z6–8



TREE LARGE

x Cuprocyparis **'Castlewellan'**

LEYLAND CYPRIS This upright, vigorous conifer is slightly slower growing than the species. It bears bronze-tinged golden foliage. Makes an excellent hedge or windbreak in large yards or gardens. Cut annually in early fall to keep in check.

↑80ft (25m) ↔12ft (4m)

☀ ☹ Z6–9